

Advice and Exercises for Ankle Fractures

Issuing institution: Doncaster and Bassetlaw Teaching Hospitals NHS Foundation Trust

Publication / update date: not stated

Original official URL: <https://www.dbth.nhs.uk/advice-and-exercises-for-ankle-fractures/>

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You have fractured your ankle. This means that there is a break in the bone.

What should I expect?

Your ankle may be painful and swollen for a few weeks. When the bones are in a satisfactory position, your ankle will be supported in a cast for four to six weeks. You may have to attend several clinic appointments to check the position of the bones. If the bones are not in a satisfactory position you may require an operation; this will be discussed with you. These injuries usually heal well naturally.

How can I help myself?

While in the cast, keep your foot raised for most of the time. Do not allow the foot to hang down for long periods as it may become swollen and painful. Keep the joints not in the cast moving, to stop them becoming stiff, by doing the following exercises three to four times a day:

fully bend and straighten your knee

move your toes as far as your cast allows

squeeze your buttocks together and relax.